

DigiPick of the month



WIN!

A Mini Keypad by Travel Pac just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should be shot by you, and should not have been published earlier. Send your picture to digipick@thinkdigit.com. The prize-winning picture will be published each month.

There's [Ctrl] and [Alt]. Now, if only I could reach [Del]...

This month's winner is Manju Jaiswall from Bangalore. She wins a

Mini Keypad worth Rs.995/-

by Travel Pac

The TravelPac mini Keypad is a 19-Key pad that is ergonomically designed with an incline for convenient data entry. This USB device is a plug-and-play and hot-swappable device. It is a lightweight device designed for a notebook.



online role-playing game *Lineage* using the man's username and password in about April last year.

Lineage is an adventure game in which players fight enemies with characters such as knights and magicians.

PROLIFIC TEXTERS

UK Text Message Record

UK mobile owners continue to break records with their text messaging. The latest figures show that 26 billion texts were sent in the UK in 2004. The figures were collected by the Mobile Data Association (MDA). They also showed that 2.4 billion were sent in December alone, the highest monthly total ever. Every day, 78 million messages are sent—which is more than one message per person in the UK—and there are no signs of a slowdown.

One of the reasons for the growing number is that people are using it to do much more. Booking

cinema tickets, text voting, and news or sports text alerts are growing popular.

THE BLUE SCREEN OF DEATH!

Gates' Windows Crash

There was a buzz in the air at the Consumer Electronics Show (CES) 2005. Only this time, the reason for excitement was not another product

launch but the keynote address by Microsoft's chairman and chief software architect, Bill Gates himself.

Returning to the International CES for the seventh consecutive year, Gates captivated the capacity audience with yet another riveting pre-show keynote address.

Before that, however, he lived through the horror of witnessing his beloved Windows display the BSOD (Blue Screen Of Death) and pop up a kernel error.

Here's to you, Bill!

When he finally got going, Gates returned to one of his favourite topics over the past few years—Realising A Digital Lifestyle.

The keynote covered virtually all aspects of digital living such as music, photos, TV, portability, gaming and so on, which can be enjoyed on various devices and platforms.



Illustration Harsho Mohan Chottoraj

People Who Changed Computing

Making Small Big

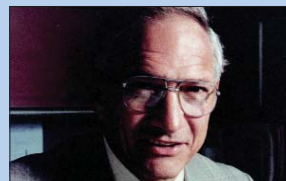
Two people invented the integrated circuit (IC) at almost the same time. Manufacturers wanted more out of the commonplace transistors. But there was a



Jack Kilby

limit on how small you could make each transistor, since it is connected to wires and devices. So, scientists wanted a miniature circuit with transistors, wires, etc.

In 1958, engineer Jack Kilby was working for Texas Instruments (TI). A year earlier, research engineer Robert Noyce, aka Mayor of



Robert Noyce

Silicon Valley, co-founded Fairchild Semiconductor Corporation where he invented the integrated chip. Noyce also founded Intel.

It occurred to Kilby, when sitting at TI, that all parts of a circuit could be of silicon.

In 1959, both applied for patents. Kilby and TI received a US patent for miniaturised electronic circuits while Noyce and Fairchild received a US patent for silicon-based integrated circuits. The two companies decided to cross-license technologies after years of legal battles, creating a global market now worth \$1 trillion a year.

Today, an IC can be smaller than a coin, and can hold 125 million transistors!